

USING COPILOT SQUAD TO AMPLIFY YOUR WORK



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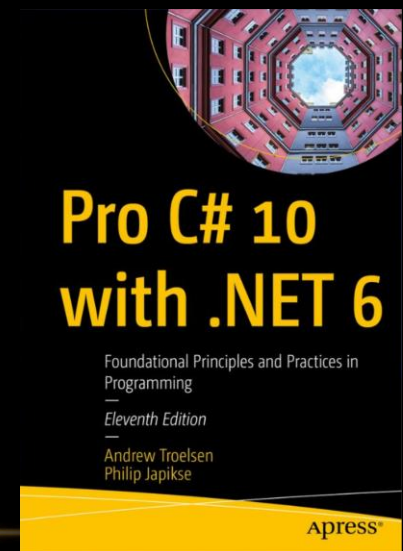


Gold



Phil.About()

- CTO/Chief Architect, Pintas & Mullins
- Author: Apress.com (<http://bit.ly/apressbooks>)
- Professional Scrum Trainer (PSF, PSD)
- Speaker: <http://www.skimedic.com/blog/page/Abstracts.aspx>
- Microsoft MVP, ASPInsider, PST, PSM II, PSD
- Founder, Agile Conferences, Inc.
 - <http://www.cincydeliver.org>
- President, Cincinnati .NET User's Group



PLEASE MUTE YOUR MICROPHONES UNLESS ASKING Q'S

```
attendees.Select(x=>x.Mike.IsOn)
```

```
{
```

```
    x.Mike.EnableSilentMode();
```

```
}
```

```
attendees.where(x => x.Dog.Barks())
```

```
{
```

```
    x.Dispose();
```

```
}
```

GITHUB COPILOT

WHAT IS COPILOT?

- AI-powered coding assistant
- Integrates in many IDE's (including VS and VS Code)
 - Analyzes the context and provides suggestions inline as you work
 - Create PR summaries
- Provides chat interface in IDE
 - Provides natural language interaction
- Copilot CLI
 - Command line interface in the terminal

GETTING GITHUB COPILOT

GITHUB COPILOT PLANS

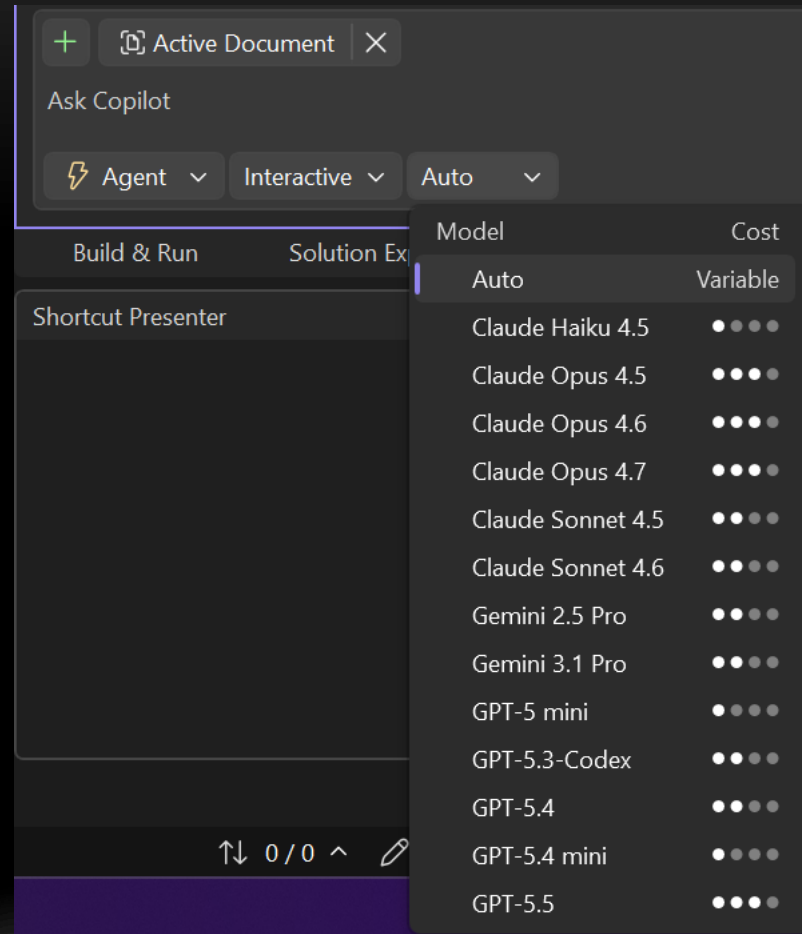
Take flight with GitHub Copilot			
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			BEST VALUE
Free For getting started with GitHub Copilot. \$0 USD Get started Open in VS Code	Pro For everyday coding with agents in GitHub Copilot. \$10 USD per user / month Get started We're gradually enabling new sign-ups. If you're unable to sign up right now, please check back soon.	Pro+ For more complex development with premium models. \$39 USD per user / month Get started We're gradually enabling new sign-ups. If you're unable to sign up right now, please check back soon.	Max For sustained, high-volume agent workflows with GitHub Copilot. \$100 USD per user / month Get started We're gradually enabling new sign-ups. If you're unable to sign up right now, please check back soon.
What's included: ✓ 2,000 completions per month ✓ Access to Haiku 4.5, GPT-5 mini, and more ✓ Copilot CLI ✓ Community Support No credit card required. Verified students have access to the GitHub Copilot Student plan. Learn more	Everything in Free and: ✓ Access to Cloud agent and code review¹ ✓ Unlimited code completion and next edit suggestions² ✓ Access to 3rd party agents (Claude Code and Codex) ✓ Model selection ✓ \$15 monthly total credits for Pro³	Everything in Pro and: ✓ Access to premium models, including Opus ✓ Audit logs ✓ 4x+ included usage than Pro ✓ \$70 monthly total credits for Pro+³	Everything in Pro+ and: ✓ Priority access to new models and features ✓ 2.9x+ included usage than Pro+ ✓ \$200 monthly total credits for Max³

<https://github.com/features/copilot/plans>

GITHUB COPILOT PLANS – FEATURES (ONLY SOME SHOWN)

Compare features	Free \$0	Pro \$10 per month	Pro+ \$39 per month	Max \$100 per month
	Get started	Get started	Get started	Get started
GitHub AI Credits				
Total GitHub AI Credits				
Credits used when interacting with Copilot features. Chat, agent mode, code review, Copilot cloud agent, Copilot CLI, and Copilot Apps consume GitHub AI Credits. Free plan supports CLI and agent mode. Learn more	 Limited chat and agent usage	 \$15 per month	 \$70 per month	 \$200 per month
Base credits	 Limited chat and agent usage	 \$10 per month	 \$39 per month	 \$100 per month
Flex allotment	—	 \$5 per month	 \$31 per month	 \$100 per month
Purchase additional GitHub AI Credits ⁴	—	✓	✓	✓
Agent mode				
Agent mode use in VS Code, Visual Studio, JetBrains, Eclipse, and Xcode	✓	✓	✓	✓
Integrates with MCP servers	✓	✓	✓	✓
Custom instructions and agents	✓	✓	✓	✓
Cloud agent				
Assign work to Copilot to research, plan, and write code – with or without a pull request	—	✓	✓	✓
Additional features				
Inline suggestions	 2,000 per month	 Unlimited	 Unlimited	 Unlimited

CHECK THE MULTIPLIERS BEFORE CHOOSING A MODEL



<https://docs.github.com/en/copilot/reference/copilot-billing/models-and-pricing>

IT'S IMPORTANT TO KNOW...

- There is an auto selection for model choice
 - Use it!
- Copilot Lies....politely...and often!

COPILLOT MODES

COPILOT ASK MODE

- Designed for learning, explanations, and guidance
 - Understanding what code does
 - Debugging
 - Learning new libraries or frameworks
 - Get guidance on algorithms or syntax
- Does NOT change your code

COPILOT AGENT MODE

- Allows Copilot to autonomously execute tasks across your project
 - Implement complex features end-to-end
 - Refactor code/tests
 - Investigate CI failures or multi-file changes
 - Automate repetitive or multi-step tasks
 - Can iterate the changes (e.g. keep fixing until project builds)
- CHANGES your code

COPILOT PLAN MODE

- Optimized for structuring complex work into actionable steps
 - Planning migrations
 - Designing feature rollouts
 - Breaking down large refactors into incremental steps with tests
 - Risk management
 - Focuses on organization and clarity
- Creates a step-by-step plan, does NOT change your code

PROMPTING

- Copilot Chat
 - Fire and forget
 - One-offs, quick fixes
- Markup files
 - Persisted
 - Can be validated by Copilot
 - Can be tweaked and rerun

INSTRUCTION FILES

INSTRUCTION FILES

- Located at `.github/*.md` (entire repo || specific folder)
 - Default is `copilot-instructions.md`
- File type/path specific
 - `.github/instructions` folder
 - E.g. C# uses `applyTo: '**/*.cs'`

AGENT SKILLS

AGENT SKILLS

- Specialized, reusable capability packages
 - Folders that contain instructions, scripts, and resources
- Can provide domain-specific workflows
- Only load when relevant, reducing context
- Placed in a subfolder (named after the skill) under `.github/skills`
- Add SKILL.MD
- Include resources (scripts, examples, etc.)
- Invoke in chat or let Copilot discover

ORCHESTRATING AGENTS

COPILOT SQUAD

- Open-source agent developed and supported by an MS employee
- Invoked via the Copilot CLI
- Builds a team of agents
 - Each with different skills (architect, front-end, back-end, tester, etc.)
 - Persisted in files to carry over from session to session
 - Each agent keeps its own context, decisions, learnings, etc.
- Controlled by a human
 - Designed to amplify humans, not replace them

GETTING STARTED

- Install the global tool:
 - `npm install -g @bradygaster/squad-cli`
- New Project:
 - `git init`
- New/Existing project:
 - `squad init`
 - `copilot --agent squad [yolo]`
 - Build your team
 - Prompt away
- Update the global tool
 - `npm install -g @bradygaster/squad-cli@latest`
- Update the repo's squad files
 - `squad upgrade`
 - Note: Only updates infrastructure, not your team, decision, or history files
- Set @copilot as an autonomous agent?
 - Creates branches/PRs/etc

BUILDING YOUR TEAM

➤ Run with the defaults or pick a universe

Universe	Capacity
The Usual Suspects	6
Reservoir Dogs	8
Alien	8
The Goonies	8
Firefly	10
The Matrix	10
Star Wars	12
Breaking Bad	12
Futurama	12
Ocean's Eleven	14
Arrested Development	15
DC Universe	18
Lost	18
The Simpsons	20
Marvel Cinematic Universe	25

BUILDING YOUR TEAM

➤ You can go off-grid also and create your own:

Name	Role	Functions
Fred	Lead	Scope, Architecture, Code Review
Daphne	Front End Dev	Razor Pages, UI/UX, Layouts
Velma	Backend Dev	EF Core, MySql, services/APIs
Shaggy	Tester	Tests, edge cases
Scribe	(silent)	Memory, decisions, session logs
Ralph	(monitor)	Work queue, backlog
Rai	(background)	RAI/content safety
Fact Checker	(verifier)	Verification + Devil's Advocate

FIRST STEPS WHEN ADDING SQUAD TO EXISTING PROJECTS

- Have the team analyze the codebase
 - Let them know the Good, the Bad, and the Ugly
 - Spend time working with them documenting:
 - Known technical debt
 - Design decisions that might not be “academically optimal”
- In short, treat the team like a new human joining your project

USE CASES

NEW DEVELOPMENT (GREEN FIELD OR ADDING FEATURES)

- Best to have ADRs, instructions, or other documentation to lay out:
 - Requirements
 - Technical rules (code standards, architectural decisions, version/package rules, etc)
 - Goals
 - Definition of done
- More details, better results

CODE REVIEWS

- General code reviews
 - The team can make MD files to document issues with priorities
 - Can also create PBIs
- Dealing with legacy code
 - E.g. find all fks and make sure the models are correct

DOCUMENTING CODE

- ADRs
- Migration plans
- Hot spots
- And more!

OTHER USERS

- Anything where you need to orchestrate a team with diverse skills

Contact Me

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www.twitter.com/skimedic

<http://bit.ly/apressbooks>

Questions?



Thank You!